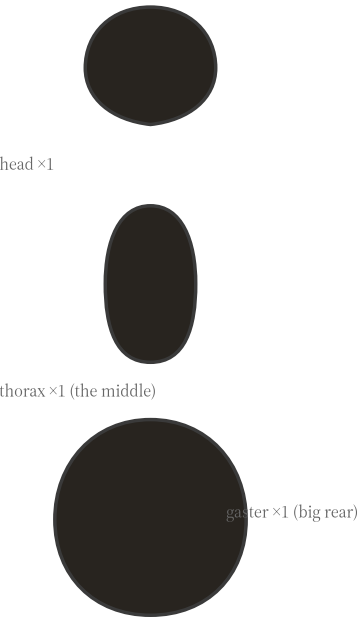


Body ×3

black · head, thorax, gaster · actual size



head ×1

thorax ×1 (the middle)

gaster ×1 (big rear)

Legs ×6

black · actual size · 3 each side



bent in the middle, like a real ant leg

Antennae ×2

black · actual size



An ant has three body parts: head, thorax and gaster, joined by a thin waist. Leave a little gap between them.

Finished!

the same pieces, assembled



3 body parts in a line · thin waist · 6 legs · ≈ 8 × 5 cm

The real thing



Lasius niger — the Black Garden Ant, in gardens and paths everywhere.

Photo © Alfie Felton, CC-BY, via iNaturalist. Photographed at Rochdale — about 20 km from Manchester.

Did you know?

- Ants live in huge colonies ruled by one big queen.
- They "talk" with smells and little touches.
- An ant can lift 50× its own body weight.
- On warm days, winged ants fly off to start new nests.
- Its 3 parts: head, thorax and gaster (the big rear).

How to make it

from your felt squares

- 1 Trace each shape onto the black felt.
- 2 Cut out all 11 pieces.
- 3 Build it on the mat →

Felt squares you'll use:

■ black — the whole ant

Just one colour — the simplest felt shopping list in the set!

Brown soil mat/pouch is premade.

Build it

lay the pieces on the mat

- 1 Lay the brown mat down — that's the soil.
- 2 Place head, thorax and gaster in a line — leave a thin waist between.
- 3 Add 6 legs from the thorax, 3 each side.

Nothing is fixed — the pieces just sit like a jigsaw.

...and again

it's a puzzle, not a glue-up

- 4 Add 2 bent antennae on top of the head.
- 5 Spread the legs so it looks ready to march.
- 6 Done! Take it apart and build it all again.

Make a whole colony and line them up in a trail!

At a glance

11 felt pieces

- 1 head (black)
- 1 thorax (black)
- 1 gaster (black)
- 6 legs (black)
- 2 antennae (black)

Finished size

≈ 8 × 5 cm

Theme: Underground. Collect the woodlouse, earthworm and ant.



A Giant Insect World felt puzzle
build it · take it apart · build it again



FuzzleWorld

downloadable felt puzzle kits

Collect the set

Meadow · Aquatic · Underground

woodlouse · earthworm · ant
butterfly · dragonfly · more...

Species: *L. niger* · Photo © Alfie Felton, CC-BY · Logo © Giant Insect World